

Yuè & the Sinitic Languages of the Pearl River Region — Unit 5.1

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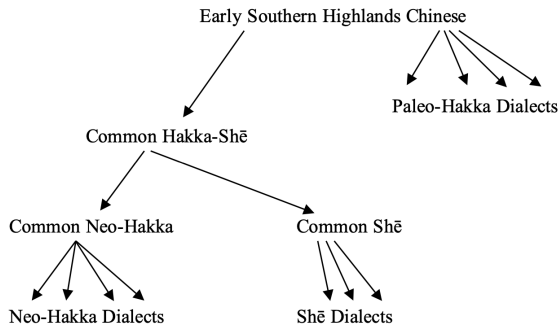
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(客家 Hakka as autonym $\subset$ what many linguists consider to be 客家)

Hakka & Shē

Coblin (2025: v)'s model



Paleo-Hakka 老客 = earlier emigrants, people not identifying as 客家, with partial Neo-Hakka traits (some of these classified are as “Hakka” in the LAC)

Hakka and Shē roughly in complementary distribution (Lo 2015)

Neo-Hakka 新客 ⊃ people with 客家 identity
Shē language 畬話: Sinitic language close to Hakka spoken by people of the 畬 ethnic group

Coblin, W. South. 2025. *Common Shē and Common Hakka-Shē: A comparative study* (Language and Linguistics Monograph Series 68). Taipei: Institute of Linguistics, Academia Sinica.

Lo, Seo-Gim 羅肇錦. 2015. 畬客關係的名實論證—客的前世是畬畬的今生是客. *Journal of Hakka Studies* 客家研究 8(2). 1–26.

Hakka & Shē

Neo-Hakka 新客 dialects, according to Coblin (2025):

1. MC sonorant initial tone B syllables are split into two groups
2. ‘to be’ 係
3. ‘I’ *ŋai
4. ‘to eat’ 食

Shē 畚：

Tone C1 merged into A1

Like Neo-Hakka, except ‘to be’ 是

Shē often a little bit influenced by neighbours,
e.g. in NE Fujian, “I” is often ŋwaj (cf. 福州 ŋwaj^B)

畚 Mand. shē^{A1}, Hakka ciā^{A2}, Canto. se^{4A2}
‘slash-and-burn farming’

Shē 畬



「畬族」 Shē ethnic group

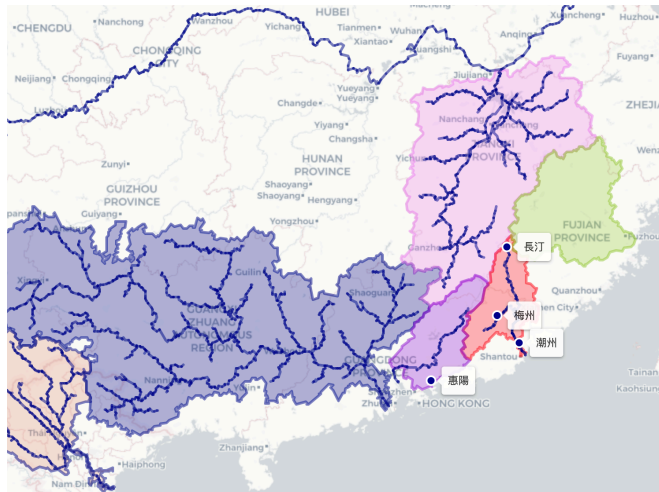
「畬話」/山客話: Sinitic language spoken by a few hundred thousand people in the 畬族 ethnic category.

「畬語」 (shee1238): divergent Hmongic language spoken by <1000 in Guangdong (增城、博羅、惠東、海豐)

(No strong evidence that these two groups are related)

(In Guizhou, another 40000 「東家人」 lumped into the 畬族 category; the speak a type of Western Hmongic)

Hakka



長汀 on 汀江：

「客家首府」

highest diversity 梅州

on 梅江：

「世界客都」

贛州 on 贛江：

「客家搖籃」

東江 area:

河源「客家古邑」

惠州「客家僑都」

惠陽

Huge expansion of
Hakka population
into e.g. Pearl
River Region

Hakka

Original Sinitic inhabitants of Hong Kong:
about half 圍頭 Waitau (莞寶粵)
about half 客家 Hakka (惠陽腔客家)
(plus other smaller Yue & Hakka & Min varieties)

Hong Kong Hakka (e.g. Lau 2021)

(劉鎮發 Lau Chunfat lau4 zan^{3C1} faat3/ Liu Zinfat liu zǐn^B făt)

Lau, Chun Fat 劉鎮發. 2021. 香港客家話研究. Hong Kong: Chung Hwa Book Co. 中華教育.

HK Hakka initials

b- p- m- f- v-, d- t- l-, z- c- s- j-, g- k- ng- h- (< 劉 Romanisation)
(ng(i)- [ŋ], 0- can have [ʔ])

(It seems that younger speakers say [ŋi])

	A	B	C	D	
	平	被	部	病	白
MC	bjæŋ ^A	bje ^B	bu ^B	bjæŋ ^C	bæk ^D
香港客	p ^h jaŋ┘ ^{A2}	p ^h i┘ ^{A1}	p ^h u┘ ^C	p ^h jaŋ┘ ^C	p ^h ak┘ ^{D2}
Canto.	p ^h eŋ┘ ^{A2}	p ^h ej┘ ^{B2}	pow┘ ^{C2}	pɛŋ┘ ^{C2}	pak┘ ^{D2}
封川粵	pɛŋ┘ ^{A2}	pi┘ ^{B2}	pu┘ ^{C2}	pɛŋ┘ ^{C2}	pak┘ ^{D2}
南寧平	pən┘ ^{A2}	pəj┘ ^{B2}	pəw┘ ^{C2}	pən┘ ^{C2}	pɛk┘ ^{D2o}
漢越	ɸŋ┘ ^{A2}	ɸi┘ ^{B2}	ɸo┘ ^{B2}	ɸəjŋ┘ ^{B2}	ɸajɸ┘ ^{D2}

粵平: Some exceptions e.g. 賊 Canto. caak6^{D2} 南寧平 tʃ^hək^{┘D2o} 'thief'

客家: Some exceptions e.g. Hakka 渠 gī^{A2} 3SG (Canto. 佢 keoi5^{B2})

漢越: Except 常船 MC dʒjaŋ^A ʒwjen^A > SV thường thuyền

HK Hakka finals

表 2-2 香港客家話韻母

韻尾 韻腹	Ø	i	u	m	n	ng	p	t	k
a	a(沙)	ai(晒)	au(燒)	am(三)	an(山)	ang (牲)	ap(颯)	at(殺)	ak(石)
i	i(西)		iu(修)	im(心)	in(新)		ip(濕)	it(息)	
u	u(書)	ui(雖)			un(順)	ung (宋)		ut(戌)	uk(叔)
e	e(洗)		eu(餽)	em(參)	en(跟)		ep(澀)	et(塞)	
o	o(疏)	oi(衰)			on(酸)	ong (桑)		ot(刷)	ok(索)
ia	ia(些)		iau(消)	iam(潛)		iang (醒)	iap(楔)		iak(錫)
iu		iui(乳)			iun(訓)	iung (雄)		iut(屈) [#]	iuk(蓄)
ie					ien(肩)			iet(決)	
io	io(噤) [#]	ioi(艾) [#]			ion(軟) [#]	iong (箱)			iok(削)
0				m(唔) [#]	n(*) [#]	ng (吳)			

1. The majority of Hakka dialects have lost rounded front vowels
2. Most HK Hakka speakers have merged -eu into -iu
3. *-ing *-ik usually > -in -it (e.g. 食 Canto. sik⁶; Hakka sīt)

HK Hakka finals

	MC	香港客	Canto.	南寧平
沉	ɕim ^A	ts ^h im ^{↓A2}	ts ^h em ^{↓A2}	tɕem ^{↓A2}
潛	dzjem ^A	ts ^h jam ^{↓A2}	ts ^h im ^{↓A2}	tɕim ^{↓A2}

MC 通攝一等 (-u^wŋ -ə^wŋ) vs. 三等 (-ju^wŋ -jə^wŋ)

	MC	南寧平	Canto.	香港客	梅縣客
聾	lu ^w ŋ ^A	luŋ ^{↓A2}	luŋ ^{↓A2}	luŋ ^{↓A1}	luŋ ^{↓A1}
龍	ljə ^w ŋ ^A	luŋ ^{↓A2}	luŋ ^{↓A2}	luŋ ^{↓A2}	ljun ^{↓A2}
工	ku ^w ŋ ^A	kuŋ ^{↓A1}	kuŋ ^{↓A1}	kuŋ ^{↓A1}	kuŋ ^{↓A1}
弓	kju ^w ŋ ^A	kuŋ ^{↓A1}	kuŋ ^{↓A1}	kjun ^{↓A1}	kjun ^{↓A1}
紅	ɦu ^w ŋ ^A	ɦuŋ ^{↓A2}	ɦuŋ ^{↓A2}	ɦun ^{↓A2}	ɦun ^{↓A2}
胸	ɦjə ^w ŋ ^A	ɦuŋ ^{↓A1}	ɦuŋ ^{↓A1}	ɦjun ^{↓A1}	ɦjun ^{↓A1}
屋	ʔu ^w k	uk ^{↓D2o}	uk ^{↓DS1}	vuk ^{↓D1}	vuk ^{↓D1}
郁	ʔju ^w k	ɲuk ^{↓D2s}	juk ^{↓DS1}	juk ^{↓D1}	juk ^{↓D1}

HK Hakka tones

1 ^{A1}	2 ^{A2}	3 ^B	4 ^C	(5/3) ^{D1}	(6/4) ^{D2}	
ˊ	ˉ	ˋ	ˋ	ˋ	ˋ	
˧	˨	˨	˨	˨	˨	(< 劉 Romanisation)
rise	low	mid	high	mid	high	

Hakka: majority of dialects D1 lower than D2 e.g. HK Hk 七 ts^hit˨ 十 sip˨

Pinghua–Yue: all(?) dialects D1 higher than D2 e.g. Canto. 七 ts^het˨ 十 səp˨

(MC 七 ts^hit^D 十 dzjip^D)

Tone sandhi:

˧ > ˧ / ˉ low or mid

客家 hak˨ ka˧, 客家話 hak˨ ka˧ va˨, 客家人 hak˨ ka˨ ɲin˨

˨ > ˨ / ˉ low or mid

大溪地 t^haj˨ k^haj˨ t^hi˨, 大溪地人 t^haj˨ k^haj˨ t^hi˨ ɲin˨

HK Hakka tones

Coblin (2025) Neo-Hakka 新客:

1. MC sonorant initial tone B syllables are split into two groups

MC	A		B		C	D	
*voiceless	A1 ʌ ¹		B ʌ ³		C ʌ ⁴	D1 ʌ ^{3/5}	
*vcd sonorant	A1 ʌ ¹	A2 ʌ ²	A1 ʌ ¹	B ʌ ³		D1 ʌ ^{3/5}	D2 ʌ ^{4/6}
*vcd obstruent	A2 ʌ ²		A1 ʌ ¹	C ʌ ⁴		D2 ʌ ^{4/6}	

The sonorant cases are said to be related to the voicing of sonorants in Proto-Min (Baxter & Sagart 2014).

	MC	南寧平	Canto.	香港客	長汀客	PMin	邵武閩	
六	l ^{-D}	luk ^{D2s}	luk ^{D2}	luk ^{D1}	təw ^{A2}	**lh-	su ^D	六
肉	ɲ ^{-D}	ɲuk ^{D2s}	juk ^{D2}	ɲjuk ^{D1}	ɲəw ^{A2}	**nh-	ny ^D	肉
綠	l ^{-D}	luk ^{D2s}	luk ^{D2}	luk ^{D2}	təw ^{C2}	**l-	ly ^{C2}	綠
玉	ɲ ^{-D}	ɲuk ^{D2s}	juk ^{D2}	ɲjuk ^{D2}	ɲəw ^{C2}	**ɲ-	ny ^{C2}	肉

HK Hakka tones

MC	A		B		C	D	
*voiceless	A1 ˩¹		B ˩³		C ˩⁴	D1 ˩³⁵	
*vcd sonorant	A1 ˩¹	A2 ˩²	A1 ˩¹	B ˩³		D1 ˩³⁵	D2 ˩⁴⁶
*vcd obstruent	A2 ˩²		A1 ˩¹	C ˩⁴		D2 ˩⁴⁶	

	MC	南寧平	Canto.	香港客	長汀客	PMin	TW	建甌閩	
買	m- ^B	maj ^{B2}	maj ^{B2}	maj ^{A1}	meɿ ^{A1}	**m-	beɿ ^B	maj ^B	買
懶	l- ^B	lan ^{B2}	lan ^{B2}	lan ^{A1}	laŋ ^{A1}		lan ^B	laŋ ^B	懶
耳	ɲ- ^B	ɲi ^{B2}	ɲi ^{B2}	ɲi ^B	ni ^B	**ɲh-	hĩɿ ^{C2}	nejɲ ^{D2}	耳
瓦	ŋ- ^B	wa ^{B2}	ŋa ^{B2}	ŋa ^B	ŋwa ^B	**ɲh-	hjaɿ ^{C2}	ua ^{D2}	瓦
網	m- ^B	muŋ ^{B2}	mɔŋ ^{B2}	mjoŋ ^B	mjoŋ ^B		baŋ ^{C2}	mɔŋ ^{D2}	網

HK Hakka lexicon & grammar

(Hakka and Yue share a lot of lexicon. Some differences:)

Some typical Hakka lexicon, e.g.:

圳 “field furrow” e.g. 深圳 cīm zùn

埔 “little plain” e.g. 大埔 tài pù

畚/輦 “slash & burn (field)” e.g. 禾輦 vō ciā

Many nouns with non-gendered semantics carry sex-specific suffixes

虱嫲 sīt mā ‘louse’, 舌嫲 sèt mā ‘tongue’, 薑嫲 gióng mā ‘fresh ginger’

蝠婆 pīt pō ‘bat’, 襖婆 āu pō ‘cotton-padded jacket’

蝦公 hā gúng ‘shrimp/prawn’, 貓公 miàu gúng ‘cat’

鼻公 pì gúng ‘nose’, 腳趾公 giōk zǐ gúng ‘big toe’

猴哥 hēu gó ‘monkey’, 罌哥 áng gó ‘bottle’

Cantonese has far fewer of these, e.g.:

蝨𧈧 sat1 naa2 ‘louse’, 蛤𧈧 gaap3 naa2 ‘frog’

腳趾公 goek3 zi2 gung1 ‘big toe’

鵲哥 liu4*1 go1 ‘hill myna’, 鼻哥 bei6 go1 ‘nose’

膝頭哥 sat1 tau4 go1 ‘knee’

HK Hakka lexicon & grammar

“What”:

Hakka: 乜介 mǎk gài (嘅 mǎi) (gài: 個 ; OC *kʰa[r]-s)

Canto.: 乜 mat1, 乜嘢 mat1 je5 (咩 me1, 咩嘢 me1 je5)
(嘢 je5: ‘thing’)

南寧平: 那門 na˧ mun˧

“To be”:

Hakka universally uses 係 (港客 hè)

Yue uses 係 (Canto. hai6), but transitions to using 是 is western Yue
(e.g. 玉林粵 ɕi˧, 南寧平 ɦi˧)

“To eat”:

Hakka universally uses 食 (港客 sit) (at least Neo-Hakka and Shē)

Yue: Cantonese uses 食 (sik6), but this is a recent Hakka influence.

Amongst Yue dialects 吃/喫 is more common, e.g. 港圍頭 吃 həkʰD1,
中山石岐 喫 jak˧D2, 南寧平 吃 het˧D1

(Canto. also has 喫 jaak3, but now considered very informal in HK.)

HK Hakka lexicon & grammar

Table 2:

Five types of colexification of EAT DRINK and SMOKE.

Type	Lexification patterns	Number of data sites
I Dislexification	EAT ≠ DRINK ≠ SMOKE	29 (18.2%)
II Full ternary colexification	EAT = DRINK = SMOKE	62 (39.0%)
III Binary colexification	EAT = SMOKE ≠ DRINK	52 (32.7%)
IV Binary colexification	EAT = DRINK ≠ SMOKE	7 (4.4%)
V Binary colexification	DRINK = SMOKE ≠ EAT	9 (5.7%)

Type I e.g. Stan. Mand. 吃飯 chī fàn ≠ 喝茶 hē chá ≠ 抽煙 chōu yān
mainly north of Yangtze

Type II e.g. HK Hakka 食飯 sìt fàn = 食茶 sìt cā = 食煙 sìt yén (also bòk yén)
mainly south of Yangtze

Type III e.g. Canto. 食飯 sik6 faan6 = 食煙 sik6 jin1 ≠ 飲茶 jam2 caa4
e.g. Yuè, Hui, Jìn

Type IV eat = drink ≠ smoke

(Their examples: 儋州客 食 sìt = sìt ≠ bòk; 南寧江南平 吃 het1 = het1 ≠ 燒 [jiu])

Type V e.g. 全州湘 吃 tɕɿ1 ≠ 喝酒 xwo1 tɕjəw1 = 喝煙 xwo1 iẽŋ1 < HM trait

HK Hakka lexicon & grammar

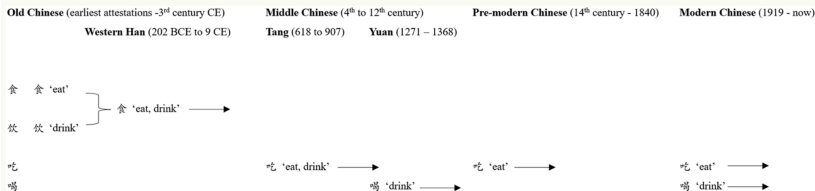


Figure 3:

Diachronic evolution of EAT and DRINK from Old Chinese to Modern Chinese (adapted from [Li and Tang 2020](#), p. 21).

(Wu 2000) Cantonese primarily used 喫 during Qīng dynasty (喫 jaak3 = 吃 hek3). 喫 is still more common than 食 amongst Yuè dialects; 食 is usually used amongst Yuè dialects which are (geographically) closer to Hakka and Mǐn dialects.

Wǔ, Wēi 伍巍. 2000. 粵語動詞”食”、”喫”研究. In Sin, Chow Yiu 單周堯 & Luke, Kang Kwong 陸鏡光 (eds.), 第七屆國際粵方言研討會論文集 (Fāngyán 方言 Special Volume), 394–396. Beijing: The Commercial Press 商務印書局.

HK Hakka lexicon & grammar

	1SG	2SG	3SG	1PL.EX	1PL.IN	2PL	3PL
港客	厓 ngāi	你 ngī	佢 gī	吾兜 ngá déu	厓哋 ngāi dí	惹兜 ngiá déu	其兜 giá déu
POSS	吾(嘅) ngá(è)	惹(嘅) ngiá(è)	其(嘅) giá(è)	吾兜嘅 ngádéuè	厓哋嘅 ngāidíè	惹兜嘅 ngiádéuè	其兜嘅 giádéuè
Can.	我 ngo5	你 nei5	佢 keoi5	我哋 ngo5 dei6	你哋 nei5 dei6	佢哋 keoi5 dei6	
POSS	我嘅 ngo5 ge3	etc. etc.		我哋嘅 ngo5 dei6 ge3	etc. etc.		
南寧平	我 ŋaɿ	你 nəjɿ	佢 kəjɿ	我隊 ŋaɿ tɔjɿ	佢隊 wənɿ tɔjɿ	你隊 nəjɿ tɔjɿ	佢隊 kəjɿ tɔjɿ
POSS	我个 ŋaɿkəɿ	etc. etc.		我隊个 ŋaɿtɔjɿkəɿ	etc. etc.		

HK Hakka lexicon & grammar

(Examples from 劉 2021)

Comparative: 過 gò SURPASS

瓦煲煲飯好食過 電飯煲

ngă-báu báu fàn hǎu-sít gò tièn fàn báu

casserole cook rice tasty THAN elec. rice pot

Object marking [OM]: 將 zióng HOLD

厝將 條鎖匙漏晦在車裏背添

ngāi zióng tiāu sǒ-sī lèu hói còi cá dí-bòi tiám

1SG OM CLF key left PFV at car inside oh!

Another construction:

Object marking [OM]: 摻 láu HELP

佢摻 吾地址寫錯晦

gī láu ngá tì-zǐ siǎ cò hói

3SG OM 1SG:POSS address write wrong PFV

HK Hakka lexicon & grammar

Recipient: 分 bín GIVE

(分 bún e.g. 分配 búnpùi;

分 bún > bín 'give' under Canto. influence? Older Canto. 畀 bi2)

送本書分 佢

sùng bǔn sú bín gī

gift CLF book DAT 3SG

Permissive causative: 分 bín GIVE

你唔好分 佢去

ngī m-mǎu bín gī hì

2SG PROHIB GIVE 3SG go

Passive: 分 bín GIVE

分 人冤枉

bín ngīn yén-vǒng

PASS person wrongly.accuse

Hakka 客家 & Sleiyip 四邑

Hakka 客家 Kèjiā & Sleiyip 四邑 Sìyì
(e.g. Lau 2002, Lin 2021)

遷界令／遷海令 The Great Clearance
(清 edicts 1661, 62, 64, 79)

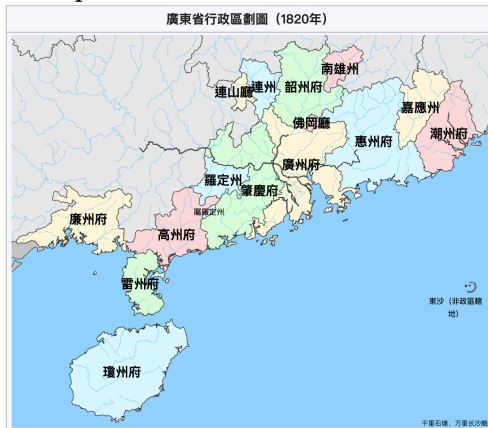
The entire coast (30-50 里 ($\approx$ 17–29 km) of land) from Shandong southward had to be cleared of civilians and civilian structures, to stop them supplying the 鄭 Dynasty (1628 – 1683; 明 loyalist) based in Tainan.

Lau, Chun-Fat 劉鎮發. 2002. 粵北土話跟客語和粵語的關係及其歸屬問題 [Northern Guangdong Tuhua' s relationship with Hakka and Yue and the question on its affiliation]. *New Asia Yearly* 新亞論叢 4. 242–249.
Lin, Cheng-hui 林正慧. 2021. 由「客人」到「客家」：嘉應州土子以「客」自我定位的過程與影響 From Kheh to Hakka: The process and influence of the Hakka self-identification in Jiaying Zhou. *Global Hakka Studies* 全球客家研究 16: 79–120.

Hakka 客家 & Sleiyip 四邑

展界令/復界令 End of the ban 1683

Not all of the original coastal inhabitants returned; large number of people from 嘉應州 moved to e.g. 潮州府、惠州府、廣州府、肇慶府 (btw, 嘉應州 was separate from 潮州府 in 1733)



Hakka 客家 & Sleiyip 四邑

First opium war 第一次鴉片戰爭 1839–1842 (caused poverty)

Red Turban Rebellion 廣東洪兵起義 1854–1856

(清 utilised existing conflicts between 「客」 (i.e. 嘉應州 migrants) and 「土」 (本地 Punti i.e. locals), 清 employed 客 to crush the Punti Red Turbans)

Punti–Hakka Clan Wars 土客械鬥

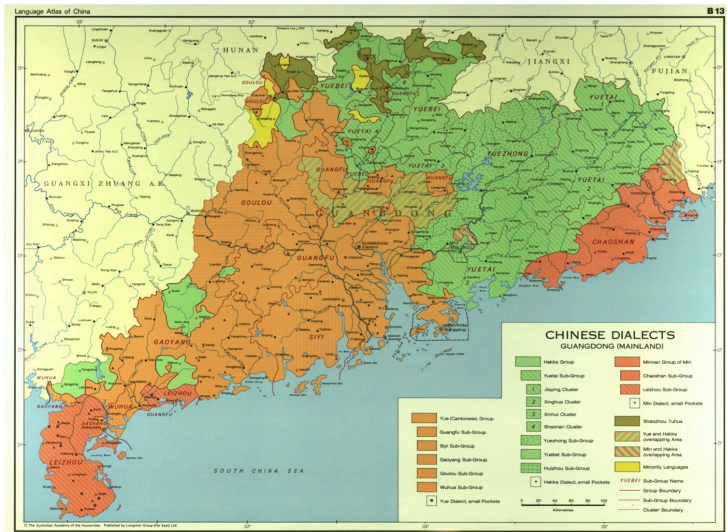
especially in 四邑 Sìyì / Szeyup (sei3 jap1) / ʎejɿ jipɿ “four counties” area (1855–1868)

In the end: 清 government expelled most 客 people out of 四邑; some moved back to 嘉應州, some moved to e.g. Guangxi or E Guangdong (forming huge enclaves), some went overseas. (Due to the fightings, many 四邑 people also went overseas)

The exonym 「客家」 was reclaimed by Hakka people in the Pearl River Delta Region, and this usage gradually spread to, e.g., parts of NE Guangdong / W Fujian / S Jiangxi.

Classification in 漢字音典 <https://nk2028.shn.hk/yindian/> <https://mcpdict.vear.vip/>

Hakka 客家 & Sleiyip 四邑



Hakka 客家 & Sleiyip 四邑

Traits of 四邑 that are like 粵:

	A	B	C	D	
	平	被	部	病	白
MC	bjæŋ ^A	bje ^B	bu ^B	bjæŋ ^C	bæk ^D
香港客	p ^h jaŋ↓ ^{A2}	p ^h i↓ ^{A1}	p ^h u↓ ^C	p ^h jaŋ↓ ^C	p ^h ak↓ ^{D2}
Canto.	p ^h ɛŋ↓ ^{A2}	p ^h ɛj↓ ^{B2}	pow↓ ^{C2}	pɛŋ↓ ^{C2}	pak↓ ^{D2}
台山	p ^h jaŋ↓ ^{A2}	p ^h ɛj↓ ^{B2}	pu↓ ^{C2}	pjaŋ↓ ^{C2}	pak↓ ^{D2}
封川粵	pɛŋ↓ ^{A2}	pi↓ ^{B2}	pu↓ ^{C2}	pɛŋ↓ ^{C2}	pak↓ ^{D2}
南寧平	pən↓ ^{A2}	pəj↓ ^{B2}	pəw↓ ^{C2}	pən↓ ^{C2}	pək↓ ^{D2o}
漢越	ɸŋ↓ ^{A2}	ɸi↓ ^{B2}	ɸo↓ ^{B2}	ɸəjŋ↓ ^{B2}	ɸajk↓ ^{D2}

Tons of Yue-like vocabulary, e.g.

嘢 ‘thing’ Canto. je5^{B2}, 中山石岐 ja^B

台山 閒嘢 hɛn^{↓A2} nje^{↓AC1} / hɛn^{↓A2} nje^{↓AC1*}

Hakka 客家 & Sleiyip 四邑

Traits of 四邑 that are like 客家 / not-like 粵:

(Only talking about core of 四邑 at e.g. 台山, 開平;

places closer to Canton e.g. 新會 have a lot more 粵-traits)

Very largely not gone through Pan-Yue vowel changes:

	MC	香港客	台山	Canto.	南寧平	
沉	dɿm ^A	ts ^h im [↓] A2	ts ^h im [↓] A2	ts ^h em [↓] A2	tɕem [↓] A2	沉
軍	kjun ^A	kjun [↓] A1	kun [↓] AC1	k ^w en [↓] A1	k ^w ən [↓] A1	軍
潛	dzjem ^A	ts ^h jam [↓] A2	t ^h jam [↓] A2	ts ^h im [↓] A2	tɕim [↓] A2	潛

No vowel length difference:

	MC	香港客	台山	Canto.	南寧平	
街	kɛ(j) ^A	kaj [↓] A1	kaj [↓] *	ka:j [↓] A1	ka:j [↓] A1	街
雞	kej ^A	kaj [↓] A1	kaj [↓] AC1	kej [↓] A1	kej [↓] A1	雞
耕	kɛŋ ^A	kaŋ [↓] A1	kaŋ [↓] AC1	ka:ŋ [↓] A1	kɛ:ŋ [↓] A1	耕
更	kæŋ ^A	kaŋ [↓] A1	kaŋ [↓] AC1	kɛŋ [↓] A1	kɛŋ [↓] A1	更

Hakka 客家 & Sleiyip 四邑

Due to there being no vowel-length contrast in 台山:
there is a mix of splitting tone D1 by vowel length

from Canto. influence (Canto. DS1 ˩ vs. DL1 ˨˩˩)

and not splitting tone D1 by vowel length

(like Paleo-Hakka tone D1 ˩)

i.e. 台山 has more many tone D morphemes in ˩ than Canto.

	Canto.	台山	惠州	香港客	
七	ts ^h et˩ ^{DS1}	t ^h it˩ ^{D1}	tɕ ^h it˩ ^{D1}	ts ^h it˩ ^{D1}	七
八	pat˩ ^{DL1}	pat˩ ^{DL1} 捌 pat˩ ^{D1} 八卦	pat˩ ^{D1}	pat˩ ^{D1}	八
法	fa:t˩ ^{DL1}	fat˩ ^{D1}	fat˩ ^{D1}	fap˩ ^{D1}	法
駱	lɔ:k˩ ^{D2}	lɔk˩ ^{D1}	lɔk˩ ^{D1}	lɔk˩ ^{D2}	駱

Hakka 客家 & Sleiyip 四邑

台山

˩	˩	˩	˩/˩
˩	˩/˩/˩	˩	˩

惠州

˩	˩	˩	˩
˩	˩/˩/˩	˩	˩

台山 also has split of MC *sonorant-initial tone B to a degree:

	MC	Canto.	香港客	台山	惠州	韶關向陽 蟲婆
買	m ^{-B}	maj ^{B2}	maj ^{A1}	maj ^{AC1}	maj ^{C1}	bwə ^{C1}
懶	l ^{-B}	lan ^{B2}	lan ^{A1}	lan ^{AC1}	lan ^{C1}	lwə ^{C1}
耳	ɲ ^{-B}	ji ^{B2}	ɲi ^B	ɲej/ɲi ^B	ɲi ^B	gi ^{C1}
瓦	ɲ ^{-B}	ɲa ^{B2}	ɲa ^B	ɲa ^{B1}	ɲa ^B	ga ^{C1}
網	m ^{-B}	mɔŋ ^{B2}	mjɔŋ ^B	mɔŋ ^{B1}	mɔŋ ^B	bɔŋ ^B

(四邑 has merger of tones A1 C1, like 畚)

台山 「我」 ɲ^uɔŋ˩ ˩ 'I' ɲ^uɔŋ˩ ˩ 'we'

惠州 「我」 ɲɔŋ˩ ˩ 'I' ɲɔŋ˩ ˩ 'we'

我 with -j not found in Yue except some neighbouring Yue dialects